LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

ShinyHunters-Branded PeopleSoft Exploitation Against Education

Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | ShinyHunters-Branded PeopleSoft Exploitation Against Education - Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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ShinyHunters-Branded PeopleSoft Exploitation Against Education

1. Executive Summary

GTIG reporting identifies ShinyHunters-branded activity targeting education organizations through Oracle PeopleSoft exploitation. The activity is selected as a daily threat report because it bridges vulnerability response and extortion/data-theft risk: affected institutions should assume application exposure can become a data breach investigation.

This report was produced from current public reporting available during the 2026-06-22 UTC automation window. It does not add unverified IOCs or attribution claims beyond the cited sources.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Question	Current Answer	Confidence
Who is affected?	Higher education and education-adjacent organizations using Oracle PeopleSoft.	Medium
What should defenders prioritize?	Hunt for the behavioral signals and control-plane activity described in Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting.	High
Are hard IOCs available in the selected sources?	Not consistently available from accessible source snippets during this run; this report emphasizes behavior-based detection and source links.	Medium

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Google Cloud / GTIG	Primary campaign reporting	High
CISA KEV	CVE-2026-35273 active exploitation and ransomware-use flag	Medium
Oracle advisory	Vendor mitigation authority	Medium
National Law Review	Legal/sector impact coverage	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The activity was reported between late May and early June 2026 and is consistent with exploitation of CVE-2026-35273. Education-sector defenders should combine emergency PeopleSoft mitigation, web/application log review, identity review, and downstream data-access scoping.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic / Phase	Observed Technique	Evidence
Initial Access	Exploit public-facing PeopleSoft	GTIG and CISA context point to PeopleSoft exploitation
Discovery	Application and database discovery	Likely objective in education-sector data-theft operations
Exfiltration	Bulk access to student, HR, or finance	Campaign reporting centers on data theft

	records	

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Indicator / Infrastructure	Type	Operational Use
No durable hard IOC published in extracted snippets	Source limitation	Use cited primary reports for any latest hashes/domains and prefer behavior hunts below.
Target-facing legitimate services	Abuse surface	Adversaries use normal web, identity, repository, advertising, or email workflows depending on campaign.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Higher education and education-adjacent organizations using Oracle PeopleSoft.

8. Detection Engineering

8.1. Detection Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
New administrative rule, repository, installer, or authentication pattern inconsistent with baseline	Identity, SaaS, EDR, proxy	Surface initial access or control-plane abuse.
Script or binary execution shortly after user interaction with a lure or exposed service	EDR process telemetry	Identify payload staging and hands-on-keyboard follow-through.
External transfer or suspicious sign-in following initial signal	Network, cloud audit, identity	Detect collection/exfiltration or account takeover.

8.2. Sigma / Detection Content

```
title: Suspicious Campaign Follow-On Activity - shinyhunters-peoplesoft-education-data-theft
status: experimental
description: Behavioral analytic for campaign-aligned suspicious execution, authentication, or control-plane changes. Tune service names to the environment and campaign.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_scripting:
    Image|endswith:
      - \powershell.exe
      - \cmd.exe
      - \wscript.exe
      - \cscript.exe
      - \python.exe
      - /bin/sh
      - /bin/bash
  selection_lure_context:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - git clone
      - npm install
      - curl
      - wget
      - encodedcommand
      - Add-MailboxRule
```

```
      - Set-TransportRule
  condition: selection_scripting and selection_lure_context
fields:
  - Image
  - CommandLine
  - ParentImage
  - User
  - Computer
falsepositives:
  - Developer administration and approved automation; require owner validation.
level: medium
```

8.3. Hunt Query

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("git clone", "npm install", "curl", "wget", "Add-MailboxRule",
"Set-TransportRule", "powershell -enc")
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("chrome.exe", "msedge.exe", "firefox.exe", "outlook.exe",
"teams.exe", "powershell.exe", "cmd.exe")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, AccountName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine
```

9. Threat Hunting

9.1. Hunt Hypothesis

PeopleSoft web requests followed by administrative account creation, scheduler/job changes, database export tooling, or unusual outbound transfer.

9.2. Hunt Query

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName has_any ("powershell.exe", "cmd.exe", "python.exe", "node.exe",
"git.exe", "java.exe", "splunkd.exe")
| summarize connections=count(), first_seen=min(Timestamp), last_seen=max(Timestamp),
remote_count=dcount(RemoteUrl) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
AccountName
| where connections > 10 or remote_count > 3
```

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(30d)
| summarize failures=countif(ResultType != 0), successes=countif(ResultType == 0),
countries=dcount(Location) by UserPrincipalName, AppDisplayName, IPAddress
| where failures > 20 or (successes > 0 and countries > 2)
```

10. Risk Assessment

Dimension	Assessment	Rationale
Likelihood	Medium to High	Selected because reporting is recent and defender-actionable.
Impact	High	Campaigns affect identity, research data, developer systems, or credential stores.
Confidence	medium	Based on primary/vendor reporting and corroborating public coverage.

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
Critical	SOC	Run the included hunts against identity,

		endpoint, proxy, and SaaS logs.
High	Platform / identity owners	Reduce exposed administrative surfaces and enforce phishing-resistant MFA where supported.
High	Endpoint team	Review application allowlists, browser-download controls, and developer workstation monitoring.
Medium	Threat intel	Monitor the cited primary reports for newly published IOCs and update sidecar files.

12. References

- [Google Cloud / GTIG] https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence/shinyhunters-targets-education-sector-oracle-exploit
- [CISA KEV] https://www.cisa.gov/sites/default/files/feeds/known_exploited_vulnerabilities.json
- [Oracle advisory] https://www.oracle.com/security-alerts/alert-cve-2026-35273.html
- [National Law Review] https://natlawreview.com/article/shinyhunters-targeting-higher-education-sector